

02 PERSISTENCE

Mental toughness is trained, not born.

SEASON
1

WEEK
2

FOCUS
GROWTH MINDSET

KEY PHRASE
“Why not me?”

SUMMARY

This practice connects a physical moment of discomfort with the emotional experience of persistence, then asks fighters to translate that skill to real-life challenges. It opens with a Stand Your Ground debate on mental toughness, effort, and confidence. Intentions asks fighters to name their push-through point. Training reviews movement and the jab, then introduces the cross technique (2), builds speed with 30-second jab-cross rounds, and works 1 · 2 on command with mitts. The practice closes with this week’s assessment: 100 clean punches, 50 1 · 2 combinations, on the mitts before one song ends, then shout-outs.

MATERIALS

- Mitts & gloves

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this practice, fighters will:

1. Connect a physical moment of discomfort with the emotional experience of persistence
2. Reflect on how persistence translates to challenges outside the gym

☐ COACH MESSAGE

15 MIN

SAY

Welcome back to Fight Like A Girl. This is week 2 of the program, and today we’re talking about persistence. First, let’s start with an activity.

ACTIVITY · STAND YOUR GROUND**6 STATEMENTS**

1. Designate one side of the room **agree** and the other **disagree**.
2. Fighters stand in the middle between each statement.
3. Read the statement aloud.
4. Fighters move to the side they believe, there is no right or wrong answer.
5. Fighters turn and talk to the people near them about why they chose it.
6. Gather responses, then read the coach response below.
7. Fighters return to the middle.

STATEMENTS & COACH RESPONSES**1 When an activity feels difficult, you should stop.**

Challenges don't mean something's wrong, they mean you're growing. When it burns, when you mess up, when you want to quit, that's the moment change happens. That's the round that makes you stronger.

2 Physical strength matters more than mental strength in a hard physical activity.

Mental strength is what keeps you going when your body gets tired. It helps you stay focused, shake off mistakes, and keep showing up. Your body follows your mindset.

3 Some people are born mentally tough and some aren't, it isn't something you learn.

Mental toughness is trained, just like footwork or combos. Every time you push through something hard, every time you talk back to the voice saying "I can't," you're building it.

4 Confident people never doubt themselves.

Confident people feel doubt too, they just don't let it stop them. Confidence isn't about being perfect. It's knowing you can keep going when things feel shaky.

5 In sports, talent is more important than hard work.

Talent helps, but hard work wins every time. Showing up, trying again, putting in the reps, that's how fighters are made. You don't need to be the most talented person in the room. You need to be the one who doesn't give up.

6 When teammates slow down, staying together matters more than standing out.

Sometimes you stay with the group to encourage and support. Other times you lead by pushing forward. Keeping your energy up doesn't mean leaving your team behind, it shows them what's possible. Be someone who brings the team forward.

SAY

So today, as we move into mitt work, I want you to remember: your mindset is your most powerful tool. You don't have to be perfect, but you do have to be willing to try, to struggle, and to grow. That's what real strength looks like.

 INTENTIONS

5 MIN

Fighters sit or stand in a circle.

SAY

Notice how it feels when you want to quit, that's your push-through point.

Today's guiding question: how do you intend to respond to your push-through point? What will you do when it feels hard to keep going?

- Each fighter shares her answer.
- End each intention with **snap clap**; the group snap claps.

 TRAINING

30 MIN

REVIEW Stance and jab

- Fighters line up shoulder to shoulder.
- Call out **boxing stance**. Review and correct stance.
- Fighters work forward with the jab at their own pace, lead foot and lead hand moving together.
- Give individual feedback on step and jab form.

CROSS TECHNIQUE (2) New skill

- Fighters line up shoulder to shoulder.
- Watch the cross (2) video, or explain the cross yourself.
- Start in stance, feet shoulder-width, hands up.
- Turn the back foot like you are squishing a bug.
- Let the foot rotation turn the hip, then the shoulder.
- Punch straight with the rear hand, using the rotation for power.
- Keep the rear knee bent for balance and strength.
- Return to boxing stance after the punch, hands up.
- Give individual feedback on step, jab, and cross form.

NAMING THE PUNCHES

Simon says · numbers to punches

- Call **cross**. Fighters throw the cross.
- Then call **1**, then **2**, so fighters connect the number to the punch, and the punch to the movement.
- Run it like Simon says: call the numbers in and out of order, faster each time.
- A fighter who throws the wrong punch sits out that round, then comes back in for the next one.

JAB-CROSS FOR SPEED

30-second rounds

- Fighters work 1 · 2 on their own for 30 seconds, then rest 30 seconds.
- Three rounds. Speed over power, hands return to the face every time.
- Call the start and end of every round so fighters can pace themselves.

WATCH OUT

- Every fighter has a default speed. This drill is about beating it, not matching it.
- Speed is already in her. Nobody is handing it to her, and nobody can take it away.
- If she is throwing at a comfortable pace, tell her she knows better than that. Then start the clock again.

MITT WORK

Instructions

- Watch the mitt-holding video, or explain mitt holding yourself.
- The mitt holder is in charge, she signals for punches by holding the mitts up, and drops her hands when the punches are done. The boxer resets her stance and waits for the signal.
- Fighters stand in boxing stance and match their partner's stance, both left foot forward, or both right.
- When the boxer throws, bring the mitt to the middle by rotating with her.
- Catch the punch, providing resistance.
- Throw left hand to partner's left hand, right to right.

HELPFUL LANGUAGE

“Like a cat pawing something.” · “Mitts throw 10% of the punch, gloves throw 90%.”

MITT WORK · 1 · 2 ON COMMAND 3 rounds

- Arrange fighters in pairs, lined up so each pair has a clear lane forward and back.
- Mitt holder and boxer stand in stance, face to face, a jab-length apart.
- Every round runs 90 seconds, then boxer and mitt holder switch positions.
- **Round 1:** the mitt holder calls **1** or **2**. The boxer answers with the right punch and clean form.
- **Round 2:** the mitt holder calls **1 · 2**. The boxer answers with the combination.
- **Round 3:** speed. Ten 1 · 2 combinations, as fast as the boxer can throw them clean.

WATCH OUT

- The mitt holder leads and the boxer reacts, there should be a slight delay between their movements.
- Front foot moves first stepping forward; back foot first stepping backward.
- Feet never come together, the stance stays wide throughout.

□ BURNOUT · ASSESSMENT

7 MIN

ASSESSMENT

One song at 160 BPM, punches thrown on the beat. Try “Hey Ya!” by OutKast. The goal is 100 clean punches, 50 1 · 2 combinations, on the mitts before the song ends. Log every fighter on page 23.

- Partners pair up with mitts and gloves. Play the song and start together, one punch per beat.
- Each fighter throws 100 clean punches, 50 1 · 2 combinations, before the song ends, then partners switch.
- Fighters count their own punches out loud; the partner holding mitts confirms the count.
- Speed over power here. Staying on the beat matters more than how hard the punch lands.
- Record every fighter’s count, whether or not she reached 100 before the song ended.
- Fighters who finish cheer on the ones still working. When everyone finishes, celebrate together.

WATCH OUT

- Arms fully extended on every punch. A short punch is a fighter cheating herself out of the rep.
- A punch that misses the beat still counts only if it is a full punch.

□ SHOUT-OUTS

3 MIN

- One person per shout-out, never the whole group.
- End each shout-out with **snap clap**.

PUNCH COUNT ASSESSMENT LOG

Week 2 baseline. One song at 160 BPM. Fighters count their punches out loud and report the number at the end. Tick **Complete** if she reached 100 clean punches, 50 1 · 2 combinations, before the song ended. Write her count either way.

DATE	SONG USED			LENGTH
FIGHTER PRESENT		COMPLETE	NOT COMPLETE	# OF PUNCHES THROWN
01		☐	☐	
02		☐	☐	
03		☐	☐	
04		☐	☐	
05		☐	☐	
06		☐	☐	
07		☐	☐	
08		☐	☐	
09		☐	☐	
10		☐	☐	
11		☐	☐	
12		☐	☐	
13		☐	☐	
14		☐	☐	
15		☐	☐	
16		☐	☐	
17		☐	☐	
18		☐	☐	
19		☐	☐	
20		☐	☐	